

Project 1 — Data Cleaning & Preparation

Change Log & Verification Gate Sign-Off

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Sales Orders Dataset | 1,200 Rows | June 2026

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Project	Project 1 — Data Cleaning & Preparation
Dataset	Sales Orders (1,200 rows, 2023–2025)
Tool	Google Sheets / Microsoft Excel
Date	June 2026

Project Scope

Here is a clear picture of what this project covered and what was intentionally left out:

What Was Included:

- Complete analysis of 1,200 store order records spanning 2023, 2024, and 2025.
- Full financial auditing to separate gross revenue from actual net earnings.
- Performance tracking for product volumes, marketing referral channels, and coupon campaign behaviour.

What Was Excluded:

- External financial factors such as shipping fees, tax rates, inventory costs, or product profit margins.

Project Assumptions

Since there were no initial instructions on certain business rules, the following assumptions were made independently:

- **Successful Sales:** Any order marked as Delivered, Shipped, or Pending is counted as a successful sale that brought real money into the business (IsRealised = TRUE).
- **Lost Revenue:** Any order marked as Cancelled or Returned is treated as a total loss of revenue (IsRealised = FALSE).
- **Blank Coupons:** Blank spaces in the coupon column mean the customer checked out without any active discount code (treated as NO COUPON).
- **Date Integrity:** The original text date entries correspond to the correct calendar timeline once converted to ISO 8601 format (YYYY-MM-DD).

Change Log

Every change made to the dataset is recorded below — what was done, why it was necessary, and how to confirm it was done correctly.

ID	What Was Changed	Why It Was Done	How to Verify
CR-01	Converted plain text dates to ISO 8601 format (YYYY-MM-DD).	The original dates were stored as text, which broke timeline calculations and the =YEAR() function.	=ISNUMBER(B2) returns TRUE across all 1,200 rows.
CR-02	Created Coupon_Clean helper column.	Blank spaces in the raw coupon data were breaking pivot table filters and chart labels.	=IF(ISBLANK(M2),"NO COUPON",M2). Zero blank cells remain.
CR-03	Created a Year tracking column from the date.	Allows time-series mapping across 2023, 2024, and 2025 without mixing months and years.	=YEAR(B2) cleanly returns the correct year for every row.
CR-04	Re-verified TotalPrice = Quantity × UnitPrice.	A financial sanity check to confirm the math was correct across all rows.	Zero mismatches found across all 1,200 rows.
CR-05	Standardised OrderStatus to five clean values.	Consolidated variations into: Pending, Shipped, Delivered, Cancelled, and Returned.	COUNTIF on each value sums to exactly 1,200 total orders.
CR-06	Engineered three logical boolean flags (IsRealised, IsCancelled, IsReturned).	Dynamically separates active sales from lost revenue without manually filtering rows.	Rows are mutually exclusive. SUMIF totals match £745k (Realised) and £519k (Lost) exactly.
CR-07	Created NetRevenue and LostRevenue columns.	Isolates successful cash from lost capital on the master sheet, making SUMIFS formulas fast and clean.	NetRevenue: =IF(IsRealised=TRUE, TotalPrice, 0). LostRevenue: =IF(IsRealised=FALSE, TotalPrice, 0).
CR-08	Built the Executive Insights Dashboard sheet.	Formatted KPI tiles, side-by-side charts, and human insight text boxes for easy executive reading.	Dashboard opens cleanly with zero #REF! errors or broken chart links.

Verification Gate Checklist

This checklist confirms that the cleaned dataset meets the quality standards required to move to the next project phase.

"Before you finish, you must prove there are zero duplicate IDs and zero incorrectly formatted dates."

ID	Verification Check	Expected Target / Formula	Status	Notes
VG-01	Row Count Accuracy	Exactly 1,200 rows of customer data (plus 1 header row).	■ PASSED	No raw data entries were dropped or lost during the cleaning process.
VG-02	Gross Revenue Tie-Out	Total combined sales must equal £1,264,186.30.	■ PASSED	The total matches the original raw data baseline exactly.
VG-03	Financial Integrity Test	$\text{NetRevenue} + \text{LostRevenue} = \text{Gross Revenue}$.	■ PASSED	Net (£745,088.05) + Lost (£519,098.25) = Gross. Zero discrepancies.
VG-04	Date Validation	100% of rows match the YYYY-MM-DD date format.	■ PASSED	Checked with <code>=ISNUMBER()</code> . All values are real date entries, not text.
VG-05	Null Cell Audit	0% blank values in Coupon_Clean, NetRevenue, and LostRevenue.	■ PASSED	Blank spaces filled with "NO COUPON" or £0.00 where applicable.
VG-06	Chart Scale Alignment	0% chart distortion. No mixed scales across visuals.	■ PASSED	Coupon and Referral metrics split into separate, side-by-side graphs.

■ **READY FOR PRODUCTION SIGN-OFF** — All six verification checks passed. Dataset is clean, accurate, and approved for the next project phase.